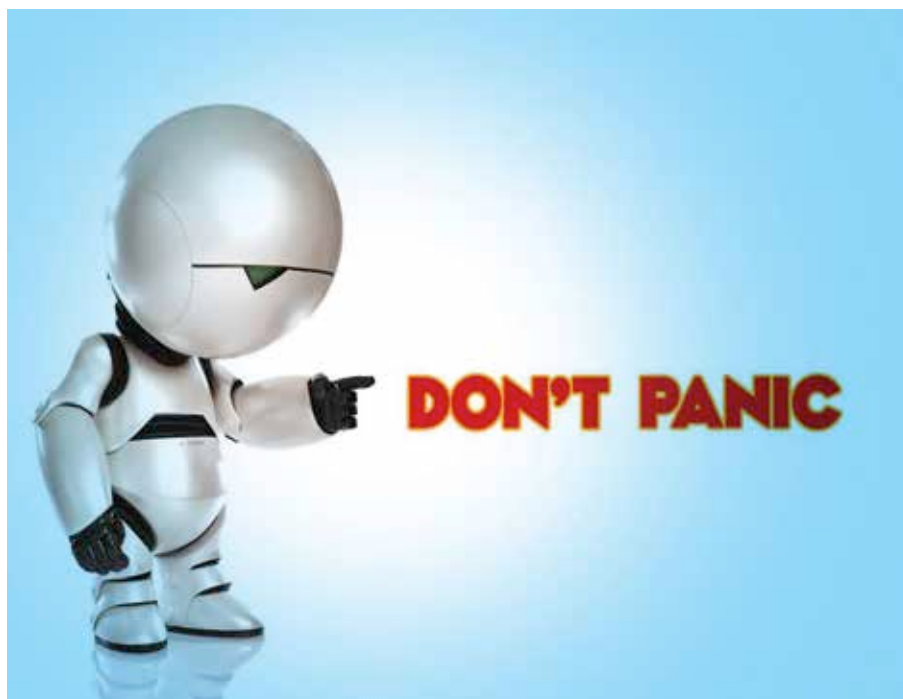




Advanced A.I. might be the answer to all of mankind's problems

rare circumstances a human may be faster than an automated solution when doing a task once, we're no match for machines when doing the task a hundred, a thousand or a million times.

In the business of print, machines first started taking away jobs as early as 1440, when Gutenberg invented the printing press. Digital printing took away the jobs of typesetters, and most printing is pretty much automated now.

Way before that, however, someone invented the wheel and levelled the playing field for the weak, allowing them to cart around stuff as easily as much stronger men. Automation is inevitable, and is the way the world will progress. However, if you're sitting around feeling

safe, thinking, "Hey, I'm a sports writer, or a stock analyst... let's see a machine do my job!", think again.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Machines may still not be able to pass the Turing test – which basically needs a machine to be indistinguishable from a human to pass. Everyone wants a Jarvis (from Iron Man), but is that really the best way to go? We keep pets, for example, and we love them. Would we really want a dog talking to you in a British accent, sitting like a human in a chair, criticising your choice of furniture, and expecting to be served tea and scones as a guest? Also, just because your dog doesn't do that, would you really consider it to be as dumb as a doorknob?

Although Digit's followed the advancement of AI for years, and even lamented that we're no closer to passing the Turing test, and thus developing "true AI", to call machines dumb would be a lie. If you head over to <http://www.forbes.com/sites/narrativescience/> you will get to read a lot of news stories, all written by an AI software. Let's take an example news short:

"Hovnanian Enterprises (HOV) Loss Expected to Narrow: Hovnanian Enterprises (HOV) is expected to book a narrower loss than a year ago when it reports second quarter

earnings on Wednesday, June 5, 2013 with analysts expecting a loss of five cents per share, up from a loss of 19 cents per share a year ago.

Analysts are expecting Hovnanian Enterprises to come in with a loss of five cents per share, a smaller loss than a year ago, when it reported a loss of 19 cents per share.

For the fiscal year, analysts are projecting earnings of nine cents per share. Revenue is projected to be \$408.6 million for the quarter, 20% above the year-earlier total of \$341.7 million. For the year, revenue is projected to come in at \$1.9 billion.

Over the last four quarters, revenue rose 29% on average year-over-year. The biggest boost came in the fourth quarter, when revenue increased 43% from the year-ago quarter."

Of course, it's not Digit-style writing, and there's no humour, no real style of a writer, but is that needed for financial news? What about sports updates?

"FINAL: Wisconsin 51, UNLV 17

Wisconsin jumped out to an early lead and never looked back in a 51-17 win over UNLV on Thursday at Camp Randall Stadium.

The Badgers scored 20 points in the first quarter on a Russell Wilson touchdown pass, a Montee Ball touchdown run and a James White touchdown run.

Wisconsin's offense dominated the Rebels' defense. The Badgers racked up 499 total yards in the game including 258 yards passing and 251 yards on the ground.

Ball ran for 63 yards and three touchdowns for the Badgers. He also caught two passes for 67 yards and a touchdown.

Wilson completed 10-of-13 passes for 255 for Wisconsin. He threw two touchdowns and no interceptions.

Caleb Herring threw for 146 yards on 18-of-27 passing. Herring tossed two touchdowns and no interceptions.

UNLV had 292 total yards. In addition to Herring's efforts through the air, the running game also contributed 146 yards for the Rebels."

Narrative Science recently got investment from a CIA-backed venture firm, which means the US government is looking at the technology, and at the minimum wants to use it to sort through the tonnes of data they have, and create a neat summary, in no time flat, for analysts. There may be other uses as well, but those would be top secret, and we're certainly not in the know.

Machines are growing smarter, as we learn new ways to program them. Fifty years from now, the job industry might

A.I., passenger aircraft and warfare



A.I. is the key to automation, but unlike visions of some megalomaniacal computer that decides to take over

the world, A.I. can be used to have a lot of fun as well. Did you know that IBM spent years programming a computer to understand human humour. Automated passenger aircraft and even warfare is also inevitable. <http://digit.in/CSJuly3>